

Hidden in Plainsight

📁 picoCTF > Forensics · + Tags

First, checking the metadata to find anything

```
(kali㉿kali)-[~/ctf/Plainsight]
└─$ exiftool img.jpg
ExifTool Version Number      : 13.50
File Name                    : img.jpg
Directory                    : .
File Size                    : 73 kB
File Modification Date/Time  : 2025:11:07 14:17:34-05:00
File Access Date/Time       : 2026:07:21 11:18:00-04:00
File Inode Change Date/Time  : 2026:07:21 11:17:54-04:00
File Permissions             : -rw-rw-r--
File Type                    : JPEG
File Type Extension          : jpg
MIME Type                    : image/jpeg
JFIF Version                 : 1.01
Resolution Unit              : None
X Resolution                  : 1
Y Resolution                  : 1
Comment                      : c3RlZ2hpZGU6Y0VGNmVuZHZjbVE9
Image Width                  : 640
Image Height                  : 640
Encoding Process              : Baseline DCT, Huffman coding
Bits Per Sample              : 8
Color Components              : 3
Y Cb Cr Sub Sampling         : YCbCr4:2:0 (2 2)
Image Size                   : 640x640
Megapixels                   : 0.410
```

this looks like a Base64 encryption. Decryption Needed.

```
(kali㉿kali)-[~/ctf/Plainsight]
└─$ echo "c3RlZ2hpZGU6Y0VGNmVuZHZjbVE9" | base64 -d
steghide:cEF6endvcmQ=

(kali㉿kali)-[~/ctf/Plainsight]
└─$ echo "cEF6endvcmQ=" | base64 -d
pAzzword
```

It reveals some kind of password. Using `steghide` should reveal the flag

```
(kali㉿kali) - [~/ctf/Plainsight]
$ steghide extract -sf img.jpg -p pAzzword
wrote extracted data to "flag.txt".
```

```
(kali㉿kali) - [~/ctf/Plainsight]
$ cat flag.txt
picoCTF{h1dd3n_1n_1m4g3_656e4d79}
```

```
(kali㉿kali) - [~/ctf/Plainsight]
$
```

flag: picoCTF{h1dd3n_1n_1m4g3_656e4d79}